

January

21

Off with his head

Louis XVI, the king of France, was executed by guillotine after he was found guilty of high treason by the French National Convention. Thousands gathered in the Place de la Révolution in Paris to witness their former ruler meet his fate.

1793



Born this day

1920 Errol Barrow, first prime minister of Barbados. He led the Caribbean island to independence from the UK in 1966. His birthday is now a national holiday.

1976

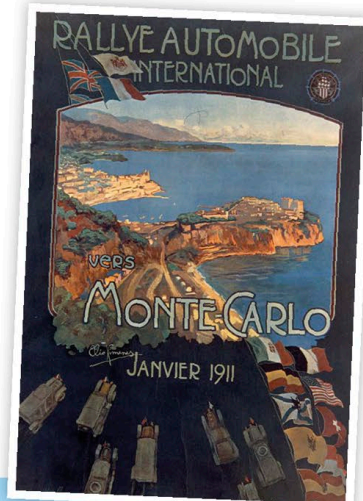
Going supersonic

Seven years after its first flight, the supersonic airliner Concorde started regular passenger service from London, UK, and Paris, France. The Concorde travelled at up to 2,179 kph (1,354 mph), twice the speed of sound.

1911

Monte Carlo Rally

In the first-ever Monte Carlo Automobile Rally, 23 cars starting from 11 different locations drove across Europe to meet up at the finish line in Monaco. The event was an opportunity to showcase the latest car technology.



Also on this day

1924 Vladimir Lenin, leader of the Soviet Union, died. His embalmed body remains on public display in a mausoleum in Red Square in Moscow, Russia.

2017 Four million people across 160 cities in the USA and many other countries took part in the Women's March, a protest against US president Donald Trump.

2020 Scientists dated an asteroid found in the Australian village of Yarrabubba at 2.2 billion years old, making it the oldest asteroid discovered on Earth.